

KISII SCHOOL 2025 PREDICTION



(KCSE PRE-ANALYSIS TEST)

101/2

ENGLISH

PAPER 2

(Comprehension, Literary Appreciation and Grammar)

TIME: 2½ HOURS



NAME.....

SCHOOL..... SIGN.....

INDEX NO..... ADM NO.....

(Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education)

INSTRUCTIONS TO THE CANDIDATES

- Write your **name**, **index number** and the name of your **school** in the spaces provided above.
- **Sign** and write **date** of examination in the spaces provided above.
- Answer **all the questions** in this question paper.
- All your answers **must** be written in the spaces provided in this question paper.

For Examiner's Use Only:

Question	Maximum Score	Candidate's Score
Comprehension	20	
Excerpt	25	
Poetry	20	
Grammar	15	
TOTAL SCORE	80	

1. COMPREHENSION

(20MARKS)

Read the passage below and answer the question that follow.

America has a long tradition of creativity. The expression Yankee **ingenuity** is an acknowledgement of this trait present Americans with a novel problem, especially technological and they are likely to come up with the solution sooner rather than later.

That is the positive side. The downside is that in policy matters, Americans sometime come up with the solutions and then look for personal problems on which to test them. Washington D.C , perhaps more than any other city in the world, has many solutions seeking problems to lock onto.

If the solution are successful, domestically or internationally, you can expect any amount of excitement and chest thumping, which is another **hallmark** of the American character. Modesty is frowned upon as something for sissies or failures. Countries and people are ready paradigm of winners and losers. Woe unto you if are a ‘loser’. You will endure all manner of taunts and putdowns.

To escape this fate, most Americans-including those who are demonstrably poor, call themselves middle class, which probably they are when compared to the poor in other places. But poverty is relative to immediate environment not to some distant places.

One of the more recent American inventions is spinning not as in making clothes (the American textile industry has long being outsourced, notably from China another low wage country), but rather as in using words and other symbols amplified by the media to paint a picture of anything and everything in alight favorable to the presenter’s side.

This past week, the world witnessed, yet again this peculiar American habit of hype and more hype, in this instance, designed to drive the point home that America’s declared policy to force-feed democracy to recalcitrant societies has just scored a **humongous** victory. Following the Iraqi elections the turn out in particular, has been hailed as a stunning victory of American policy. Pitted against Iraqi Jihadists who are waging a relentless and ruthless insurgency, a scintilla of validation of America’s Iraqi policy was all that was all necessary to set off celebratory fireworks.

To those who recount narratives (the spinners), whose job it is to put a bright glass on things a clear picture of winners and losers are the Neanderthals; “ thugs and assassins” in the words of the newly sworn in secretary of state Condeleeza Rice-the insurgents who threatened to wreak havoc on election day in Iraq but were thwarted.

The high turnout was read as a violation of many things that were most likely absent from the minds of those Iraqi voters who cast their ballots. Before it was even known whom they had voted for and why, the whole enterprise was turned into cause for chest thumping by some American politicians, prompting John Kerry the loser in the November presidential race, to warn against hyping the Iraqi election.

Who will listen to a loser? This is America! By the time Kerry spoke, the spinning was in full gear. It was another turning point, declared elated talking heads. Never mind that there have been numerous'' turning points'' in Iraqi's tortured post-invasion experience. The winners were emerging.

A few voices have urged caution but they are drowned out by the self-congratulation that has **engulfed** just about every major media outlet here.

It is reminiscent of the chatter that followed Saddam Hussein's capture. That was another turning point. The irony is that America has been through this before, in a different place, with almost the exact same headlines. In the late 1967, many American newspapers published flowery and upbeat stories on the elections held in South Vietnam at the height of the war. The turnout was nearly 83% despite Vietcong terror. The election was declared a success and a turning point that would lead to stabilization of the country and eventual defeat of the insurgents. Of course, nothing of the sort happened.

History does not **invariably** repeat itself. Sometimes it does. Whatever one might think of it, history does always serve up many lessons. One of them is that a dose of modesty is always in order when confronted with vast historical forces or when seeking to rearrange complex societies their go hundreds, if not thousands, of years back.

What may look like victory as first sight may turn out to be another opening to a complex and trying situation that control produce winners or losers. It looks like this what is emerging in Iraq. The millions who headed to the polls on the instruction of their electrical leaders (remember Grand Ayatollah Sistani declared it a religious duty to vote? May or may not have had a clear idea of what society were hoping to create. Their leaders probably do.

Iraqis voted and they are justifiably proud of it. However, this should not be made to look like a first in the Islamic world, as it is being painted in the media. Not too long ago, an Islamic party had won a clear and convincing victory in free and fair election in Algeria. It was never allowed to assume power. The international authorities desisted from calling the denial an affront to democratic practice. The man who cancelled the Algerian election results if feted in the very same quarter that now preach democracy.

Society's broken tyranny, war, fragmentation and other ills are not served by putdowns of important segments within them.

The approach may produce winners in the short term but for more losers in the end. Moreover, here we are talking of those who could lose everything, including their lives, on a mass scale. A little modest may just be what is needed to get people across the divide talking. After all, in the end, we are all losers.

Questions

a) What is the negative side of America's long tradition of creativity?

(2marks)

.....
.....

b) “Woe unto you if you are a loser.” What does the author mean by this statement?(2marks)

.....

.....

c) Identify and explain an instance of irony in this passage.

(3marks)

.....

.....

.....

d) What is the author’s attitude towards the Americans? Give reason for your answer. (2marks)

.....

.....

.....

e) ‘...and the losers are Neanderthals;...’ Explain how the Neanderthals became losers according to this passage. (2marks)

.....

.....

.....

f) What according to the passage is referred to as spinning? (2marks)

.....

.....

g) Identify one American policy discussed in this passage. (2marks)

.....

.....

.....

h) Explain the meaning of the following words as used in the passage. 5marks)

i)Ingenuity.....

- ii) Hallmark.....
- iii) Engulfed.....
- iv) Humongous.....
- v) Invariably.....

Question 2

Read the following excerpt then answer the questions that follow:

Mossi: *(Looking at Mr. Pirro)* This thing we are talking about is a school project under their control! *(turning to face the principal)* it is, therefore, within your powers to find a way around it. *(pauses, then turns to face Nicole)* Think about it. You are the center of it! Figure out a way... like writing to the Ministry of Education indicating that there are some fundamental errors in it that you need to attend to...get what I mean?

Nicole: I am afraid, your worship, the assessment of innovations was done by senior officers at the Ministry of Education. Experienced software engineers were also involved. It passed all the tests and no errors were found.

Mossi: *(with a raised voice)* My good teacher! I am the Mayor of this Municipality, voted in by hundreds of thousands of people, directly or indirectly. My decisions **supersede** those of any education official anywhere in this country. Do as I say! Write a letter expressing reservations about this thing, technical or otherwise, and then leave the rest to me.

Pirro: Pardon me, Your Worship, but they cannot overrule the Minister...

Mossi: I cannot argue with a simple Chairman of a Local School Board. I am Mayor Mossi-oa-Tunya, the smoke that thunders. I have been given express mandate by the people of Maracas Municipality to protect their public interest. That is what I am doing and that is what I must do!

Nicole: Your Worship, the App has been online for a month now. It has been taken over by the National Information and Communications Technology Corporation. There is little we can do now.

Mossi: *(Raising his voice even louder and pointing at Nicole with his walking stick)* Do as you are told. Go now and write that letter and copy my office through your School Principal. I expect to find a copy of the letter in my office in one-hour's time latest.

Nicole: *(Rising to her feet and nodding, but with a look of objection on her face)* I will do what is right. *(Mossi and other guests stare at one another in silence as Nicole exits the hall. Her footsteps can be heard reverberating in the corridor like castanets.)*

Ramdaye: *(Breaking the uneasy silence)* I wonder if she is going to do it.

QUESTIONS

a) What happens before this excerpt? (4 marks)

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

b) How are the following characters portrayed in the excerpt? (4 marks)

Nicole

.....

.....

Mossi.....

.....

c) Identify and illustrate any two thematic concerns evident in the excerpts (4 marks)

.....

.....

.....

.....

d) Identify any ironical situation in this excerpt (2 marks)

.....

.....

.....

e) Describe the tone of Mayor Mossi in this excerpt? (3 marks)

.....

.....

.....

.....

**f) Experienced software engineers were also involved. It passed all the tests, and no errors were found.
(Join using a pronoun) (1 mark)**

.....

.....

g) Explain what happens immediately after the excerpt (4 marks)

.....

.....

.....

.....

b) Explain the meaning of the following words as used in the excerpt (3 marks)

supersede.....

mandate.....

reverberating.....

Question 3;Oral Narrative

Read the following narrative and answer the questions that follows. (20marks)

A long time ago, there were two men who had been friends for many years. They were like brothers. Now , there came a time when they both wanted to get married. They decided would marry one woman with whom they had both fallen in love.

Between the two of them they had enough bride wealth to pay for the woman, because each of them had half the required bride price. The woman's father accepted the bride wealth and gave permission for his daughter to get married to the two young men. The made an agreement among themselves and laid down conditions that were going to guide them in sharing this woman as a wife . One of the friends chose to have exclusive right to the woman's **from** the waist to the legs while the other one chose from the waist upwards to the head.

Whenever the man who had chosen the upper part desired the woman, he called her into his house and had a pat on her and that was all. The other man who had chosen the lower parts took the woman to his house for the night.

This arrangement worked until the woman became pregnant.

“After delivery.’ The friend who owned the upper part said to the woman, “I won’t allow you to breastfeed because the baby isn’t mine.”

The woman objected loudly saying , “But the baby is mine and the breast are also mine so I’ll have to breast feed it.

“ No, and yes, the baby is yours and my friends, but the breasts happen to be yours and mine, so you and my friends should try to get milk for your baby from elsewhere. I don’t want you to feed it from your breasts,” The man was serious and the woman got very worried.

“Perhaps my friend who owns your upper part can pay me back the part of the bride wealth I paid for you then he can have you as his wife and you won’t have to be a wife to both of us,” the other husband

offered. However, he knew very well that his friend had neither money, cattle nor anything else which he could refund to him as part of the bride wealth he had paid for their wife. The matter was taken to the elders for discussion and settlement. After much consultations, it was decided that, that woman should be married to the man who owned the upper part of the body as the baby had to be fed. The friends disagreed and had their first serious quarrel. The situation was critical, so the father of the baby conceded and allowed his friend to refund the share of the bride wealth he had paid. It was then agreed by the elders that the woman should be exclusively married to the man who owned the breasts. This development marked the end of the friendship between the two young men.

QUESTIONS

a) Classify the above genre

(2marks)

.....

.....

.....

b) Identify the typical features of oral narrative evident in the genre above.

(4marks)

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

c) What makes relationship between the two friends ironical?

(2marks)

.....

.....

.....

d) Comment on the character traits of the two husbands.

(4marks)

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

e) Which is the most appropriate audience for the above oral narrative? (2marks)

.....

.....

.....

.....

f) Highlight two social activities evident in the above oral narrative. (2marks)

.....

.....

.....

g) What is the attitude of this society towards women? (3marks)

.....

.....

.....

.....

h) The situation was critical, so the father of the baby conceded and allowed his friend to refund the share of the bride wealth he had paid. (Begin: So.....) (1mark)

.....

.....

GRAMMAR (15MARKS)

1. Use the correct form of the words in brackets to fill in the blank space. (3marks)

- i) Jane was.....about taking up the job (decide)
- ii) I told her that I wasfor her help. (gratitude)
- iii) There is little evidence of(diligent)

2. Underline the main clause in the following sentences. (2marks)

- i) I saw the woman who gave birth to twins.
- ii) If you work hard you will pass your examinations

3 Use the most appropriate choice to fill in the blank spaces. (2marks)

- i) Mr Kantai sent two students(I, me) and John out of his class.
- ii) Kemunto introduced Wafula andto his father(her,she)

4. Underline the gerund in the following sentence. (1mark)

Diana is studying but swimming is her hobby.

5 .Rewrite the following sentences as instructed. (3marks)

- i). He was obviously angry with you. (Begin His...)

.....

- ii) He did not apply for the job. He did not get it (Begin: Had.....)

.....

- iii) James wondered how the accused will clear their names. (Rewrite in direct speech)

.....

6. Explain the difference between the following sentences. (2marks)

Has the donkey eaten Mary?

Has the donkey eaten, Mary?

.....

.....

.....

.....

7. Rephrase the phrasal verb underlined with one word similar in meaning. (2marks)

- a) The project has really eaten into my savings.

.....

b) He had his dog put down because it was in a lot of pain from its tumors.

.....

THIS IS THE LAST PRINTED PAGE!